



Twitter extends 280 characters to everyone

After admitting that the 280 character testers didn't really use the feature much, Twitter has extended the feature to almost all users. <http://digit.in/Twtr280>



Notch Remover for iPhone X

App to make the iPhone X notch invisible by introducing a black bar on top of your screen now live on the App store. <http://digit.in/HateNotch>

As you sow..

India's next major startup boom might come from a sector that has existed since the dawn of human civilisation

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or a country where more than a third of the population depends solely on

agriculture as source

of income, we are awfully ill-informed about the industry. In fact, if you've been a mostly urban-dwelling individual, it is highly unlikely that you've ever seen a farm in real life. And that apathy is often reflected in the condition of farmers in our country. For an industry that we rely so heavily on, we've seen little to no innovation in agriculture. That is, until Indian startups turned their attention towards the industry.

There's a wide array of challenges for agritech startups to solve. Decreasing agricultural land with growing population levels, decreasing ground-water levels, lack of mechanisation, absence of organised marketing structure, inadequate transportation and storage facilities, lack of credit - the list is endless. But the startups involved in the currently growing agritech sector are looking to change all of that. Be it getting the produce to retail at a better price for the farmer or building a better crop of farmers with knowhow and expertise in good farming practices, these startups are bringing the much needed innovation that most other industries in India are seeing right now. But is it really doing anything to make the lives of our farmers better? Let's find out.

THE MIDDLEMAN PROBLEM

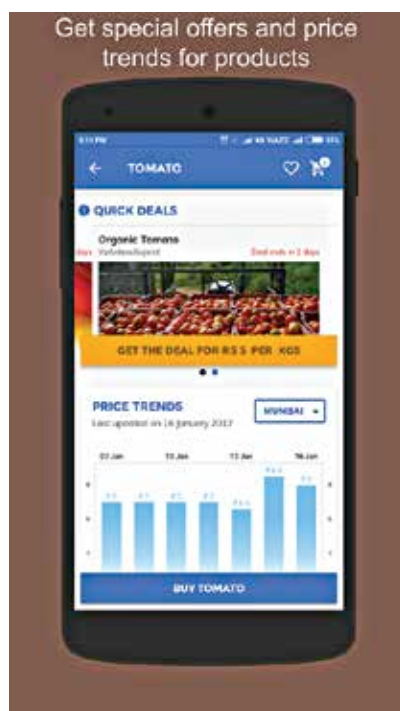
One of the most significant pain points in the current agricultural ecosystem

is the impact of middlemen. Do not mistake their role to be that of logistics - it's way more. On one hand, middlemen try and give farmers the lowest possible rate for their produce. On the other hand, the same produce gets marked up multiple times before it gets to a customer. The lion's share of the price paid goes to the middlemen, which leaves both the customer as well as the farmer on the losing ends of the deal. But certain startups are trying to

change that by removing the middlemen from the equation.

Take Farmily, for instance. The app-based platform allows farmers to list their farm and produce online. They can specify details pertaining to availability, expertise and even add pictures of their farm. Customers, on the other hand, can look for particular produce by a text-based search on the app, within a specific radius of their current location. When they find it, they can get in touch with the farmer on the app itself and eventually establish a trade. Farmily takes care of the rest and ensures that the product is delivered properly. They are responsible for taking charge of the crop at the farm gate and delivering it to the buyer. While verification, payments etc are mostly on manual intervention basis right now, they are working on digitising the entire process. As for monetisation, Farmily goes for a commission on sales generated, margins on logistics, financing and other value added services.

On the opposite side of the demand-supply spectrum, Truce allows users to specify requirements, in terms of product, variety and grade, and then it highlights quotes from sellers. Once you've finalised on a suitable price, payment is processed digitally and the seller dispatches the product to you. In terms of maturity, Truce's offerings are up there with some of the best in the market.



Truce offers a seamless experience combined with useful insights